



Free Netflix in Kenya

Netflix debuts an all-new free tier for Android users in Kenya.
<https://digit.in/oct21-83>



Brazil fines Apple a second time

Brazil will fine Apple again for not including charger with iPhone 13.
<https://digit.in/oct21-94>

to be used as wearables, and that memory storage devices without moving parts would be invented (the solid state drive). Kurzweil is still in the business of making predictions, and believes that in the future, humans will be able to 3D print replacement organs using stem cells. He also anticipates the next level of annoying popups, which are XR goggles that can read your emotions, figure out what you need, and display it on screen, like the name of an acquaintance you are struggling to remember.

WILLIAM GIBSON

The word “cyberspace” was coined by William Gibson, and he is frequently credited with predicting the rise of the internet, even before personal computers took off. A visualised form of the internet was known as “The Matrix”, which is literally the world of YouTube, Instagram and TikTok. The kind of underground distributed network that William Gibson was referring to can actually be better applied to distributed ledger technologies, such as Ethereum. Gibson could see dark forces hiding in the underbelly of the internet, before there really was the internet, and foresaw internet forums. He predicted the rise of influencers as a new brand of celebrities, that reality television would be a form of entertainment, and correctly predicted that troll farms would organise themselves into the internet hate machine.

RICHARD DAWKINS

Dawkins coined that one trending keyword that explains all millennial and post millennial preoccupations, and that word is ‘memes’. He then went on to ask a puzzling question – does the influence of human DNA extend to the technosphere as well? Dawkins’ pioneering work influenced engineers to work on evolving software that combine to make baby software, that then churn out the solutions required by humans. Dawkins also warns of dire climate consequences, WMDs being avail-

able in the hands of non state actors participating in guerilla warfare, and virtual realities that would be indistinguishable from the real thing. Dawkins expects humanity to establish a permanent settlement on Mars within the next 50 years. He also predicts that we may receive signals from intelligent extraterrestrials, but will not be able to have a conversation because of the speed of light.

JAMES BURKE

Burke was the “science detective” well known for his tangential thinking that allowed him to connect seemingly disparate events into one coherent narrative. Apart from widespread adoption of comput-

corner, but also the mobile computing device, which he saw more of a sidekick than a pocket PC. He also predicted intelligent machines, that are along the lines of IoT devices. The big prediction that Asimov got right was the proliferation of online education platforms, by anticipating something that is identical to the MOOCs today. Asimov also said that the first space settlement would be on the drawing boards in 2019, with humanity returning to the Moon, not in a national mission but an international project. The Gateway qualifies as just such a space station. Fortunately for the birds, we do not have solar energy farms in space microwaving energy down to base stations on Earth.



The Gateway.

ers by business and schools, Burke correctly predicted the centralised hoarding of personal data by big tech companies to be churned by machine intelligence. Consequently, he also correctly predicted that people would be more amenable to discussing their personal lives with strangers. We now live in a world where privacy is considered to be dead. His best prediction though, is the rapid acceleration of innovations, and Burke believes that humans are only getting started, and that the future will now change even more rapidly than it has been changing so far.

ISAAC ASIMOV

Asimov was asked to predict the future as we are experiencing it today, in 1984. He predicted the home computer, which was just around the

CARL SAGAN

Sagan specifically laid out his vision for what the year 2021 would be like in 1995, and got a lot of things right. To start with, he was one of the first to call out Star Wars for a lack of diversity, considering how not all the skin colours of the Earth were represented, let alone the rest of the galaxy. He bemoaned the fact that Chewbacca, the wookiee, did not get a medal. Sagan also correctly predicted that manufacturing would move out of America, that technological power would be focused in the hands of a select few, as well as acute information fatigue in a society plagued by the spread of fake news, pseudoscience and misinformation. Sagan also anticipated that content would grow increasingly shorter, anticipating Vins, Snaps, Stories, Clips and Reels. 